

Apps compared by step

Step	Moni	PayOn	Unlock	Sono	TUS	Simple	Numur	Pocket	M Credit	LendMN
Phone number required	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●
OTP	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●
PIN / password	●	●	—	●	●	●	●	●	●	●
ID card scan	◐ via DAN	◐ via DAN	◐ via e-Mongolia	◐ via DAN	—	—	◐ via DAN	—	◐ via DAN	● yes (photo)
Face verification	—	—	—	—	—	—	◐ partial (KYC)	—	—	● yes (selfie)
Bank account connection	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
Loan amount selection	○ hidden	○ hidden	○ hidden	○ hidden	—	—	○ hidden	● range shown	● slider	○ hidden
Approval screen	◐ not-eligible	◐ not-eligible	◐ not-eligible	◐ not-eligible	◐ not-eligible	● contract	◐ not-eligible	—	● online contract	● contract / not-eligible

Common onboarding patterns

PATTERN 1

Phone + OTP + Password trio

All 10 apps build their account on this triad. OTP is sent over SMS, password is created next, then a 4-digit PIN is layered on as a session-level shortcut.

PATTERN 2

e-Mongolia / DAN handoff for KYC

Identity is delegated to the government DAN platform via e-Mongolia. The app deep-links out, the user authenticates there, and returns with verified profile data. 7 of 10 apps use this.

PATTERN 3

3MC credit-bureau check

After identity, the app pulls a Mongolian Credit Bureau (3MC / "Сайн скор") score. Used as an automated gate — pass shows a green check, fail dead-ends in "Not eligible".

PATTERN 4

Multi-screen welcome carousel

Onboarding 1, Onboarding 2, sometimes Onboarding 3 — cartoon mascots and value-prop copy before the user can type anything. Average 2.6 screens before the first field.

PATTERN 5

Dual credential (password + PIN)

8 of 10 apps make users create a password first, then a 4-digit PIN. The PIN is the day-to-day unlock; the password is for password resets. Users rarely realise this.

PATTERN 6

"Not eligible" hard stop

9 of 10 apps end the flow with a "Not eligible" / age-limit / KYC-fail screen and no path back. There is no waitlist, no co-signer option, no retry timer — the funnel just ends.

Friction points

● ISSUE 1

Carousel before content

2–3 mandatory welcome screens before the user can do anything. By the time they reach the phone-number field, attention is already taxed.

● ISSUE 2

Context loss in e-Mongolia handoff

The user is dropped into the e-Mongolia app/ browser, finishes a separate flow, and is sometimes returned without progress feedback. Some apps don't auto-resume.

● ISSUE 3

Credential overload (password AND PIN AND OTP)

Users are asked to remember an SMS OTP, create a password with 4 character-class rules, then create a 4-digit PIN — within ~90 seconds.

● ISSUE 4

Hidden loan terms

8 of 10 apps reveal the loan amount, term, and rate only after KYC. The user invests effort with no view of what they're qualifying for.

● ISSUE 5

"Not eligible" with no recovery

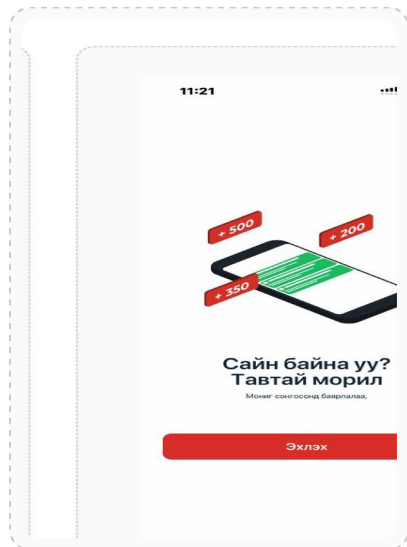
A red modal saying "Sorry, we cannot offer you a loan" with an OK button. No reason, no next step, no help link. (See M Credit "Амжилтгүй" dialog.)

● ISSUE 6

Generic OTP-fail with hotline only

When OTP delivery fails the app shows "Please call 1900-1188". Phone call is the only escape — no in-app retry timer, no "resend in 60s" affordance.

What worked well



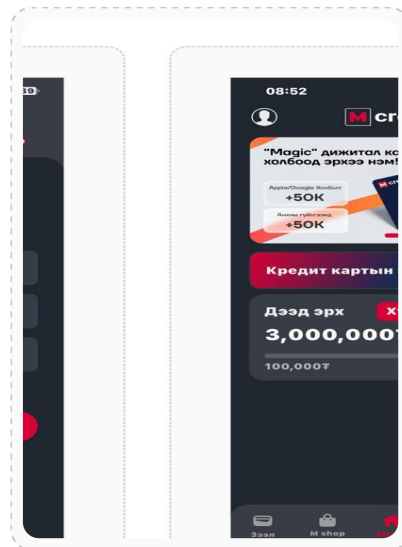
Animated reward coins on welcome — Moni

Floating +500 / +200 / +350 coins on the first screen quietly promise a reward. The "Эхлэх" (Start) CTA gets a single, big red button — no choice to delay.



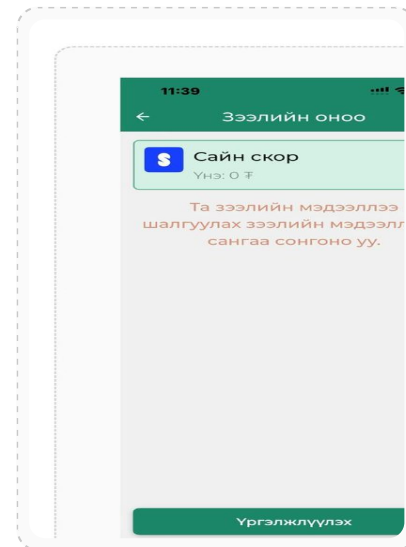
Loan range stated upfront — Pocket

Before any sign-up step, Pocket shows "500,000T — 15,000,000T · 4–12 month term · 4–12 repayments". The user knows what they're qualifying for before they invest effort.



Live loan-amount slider on home — M Credit

"Дээд эрх 3,000,000T" is shown with a visible slider after auth. The mental model is "here is your limit; pick an amount" — much clearer than a hidden number.



Green success state for credit score — Sono / Numur

A green header, a "Сайн скор" (good score) chip, and a single primary CTA. The user understands they've passed the gate without having to read paragraphs.

Improvement opportunities

● HIGH PRIORITY

Show loan terms before sign-up

Surface the amount range, rate, and term on the very first screen — not after 8 fields of KYC. This is the single biggest conversion lever.

Collapse password + PIN into one

Pick one. A 4-digit PIN protected by biometrics is sufficient for a session credential; the password adds friction without security gain.

Make "Not eligible" actionable

Replace the dead-end modal with: reason, retry window (e.g. 90 days), what to improve, and a "Notify me when I qualify" toggle.

● MEDIUM PRIORITY

Reduce welcome carousel to 1 screen

Combine the 2–3 onboarding cards into one screen with three short bullets. Skip-button visible from frame one.

Standardize e-Mongolia handoff

Use a single shared component: pre-handoff explainer, then deep-link, then in-app success state. No app should leave the user wondering if they returned.

Make OTP errors recoverable in-app

Add resend countdown, "Call instead" as secondary action, and a "Wrong number? Edit" link — never a single OK button.

● LOW PRIORITY

Consistent CTA labels

"Үргэлжлүүлэх" / "Дараах" / "Эхлэх" all mean "continue". Pick one verb per app and stick with it.

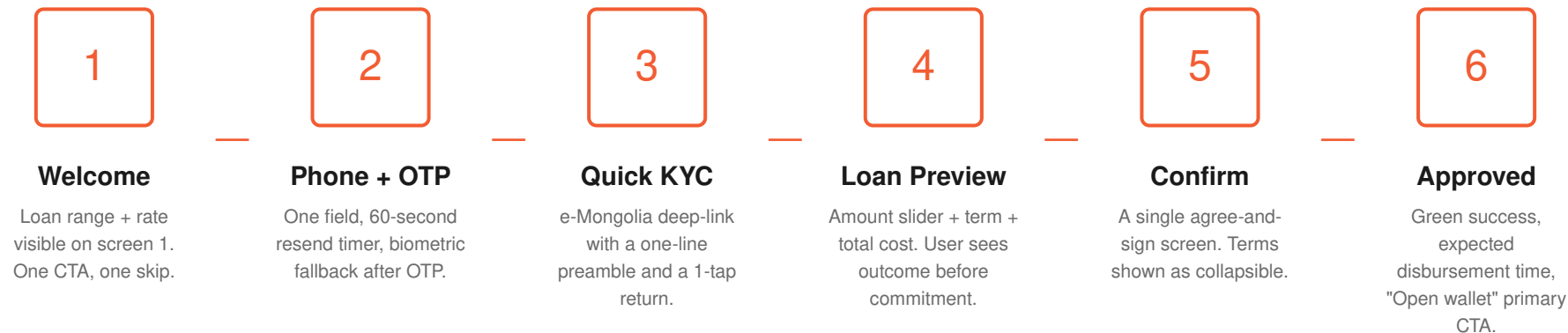
Hide password rules until typed

The "8 chars, 1 number, 1 capital, 1 special" bullet list above every empty field is intimidating. Reveal rules on focus, check them inline as the user types.

Move Terms of Use to a checkbox

A wall of legal text on screen 5 is universally skipped. Move to a one-line checkbox with a "View terms" link.

Recommended ideal flow



Six steps, average completion target under three minutes. The first screen shows the loan range, the fourth shows the actual deal; everything in between exists only to satisfy regulation and risk.

Summary & next steps

SUMMARY

Across 10 Mongolian loan apps, onboarding converges on a near-identical pattern — phone + OTP + password, e-Mongolia for KYC, 3MC for credit, "Not eligible" as the only failure state. The flows are technically complete but front-load friction and hide the one thing a borrower actually wants to see: how much they can borrow and at what rate. The biggest opportunity is to put the deal on screen one and let regulation catch up behind it.

NEXT STEPS

- Prototype a "deal-first" welcome screen and A/B-test against the current carousel.
- Standardise the e-Mongolia handoff and "Not eligible" recovery flow as shared components.
- Run a 5-user moderated study on the prototype to validate the 3-minute completion target.